



Introducing Maria Teleki

Maria Teleki is a PhD Candidate in Computer Science at Texas A&M University, where she studies how AI holds up in socially complex situations: how people actually speak, who they are, and the institutions they work in. This past summer, she was a Student Researcher on Google DeepMind's Frontier AI team. Her research appears at top AI venues including ACL, CHI, FAccT, INTERSPEECH, and ICASSP, and she has mentored 12 students who have worked at NVIDIA, Amazon, Meta, and Google. A Texan from Cedar Park, Maria also consults with companies on AI policy and speaks to industry teams and public media about using AI well. She defends her PhD and becomes "Dr. Teleki" in May 2027.

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Ways you can use AI right now

Maria Teleki

PhD Candidate in Computer Science
Texas A&M University

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The fine print

- **For education only.** This talk is general information about using AI tools. It isn't legal, HR, compliance, or other professional advice for your situation.
- **My own views.** I'm speaking as an individual, not on behalf of Texas A&M University, Google DeepMind, JLL, or any other organization.
- **Check your policies first.** Follow your company's rules and use approved tools, especially with employee or confidential data. Talk to your legal, HR, or IT team before acting on anything here.
- **No guarantees.** AI tools change fast and can be wrong. Examples are illustrations, not endorsements, and you're responsible for how you use AI outputs.

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Maria Teleki

I study AI in socially complex situations

PhD Candidate in Computer Science,
Texas A&M University
Defending my PhD in
May 2027, whoop!

**Worked at Google DeepMind
this summer**

Student Researcher, Frontier AI team

Publish in top AI conferences

ACL, CHI, FAccT, INTERSPEECH, ICASSP

Mentor 12 students

Now at NVIDIA, Amazon, Meta, and Google

**Speak to industry teams and
public media**

IPT Global, Revionics, MASKulinity Podcast

I study how AI holds up in socially complex situations

How we speak

Is AI robust to how people naturally speak?

Who we are

Is AI robust to each person's uniqueness?

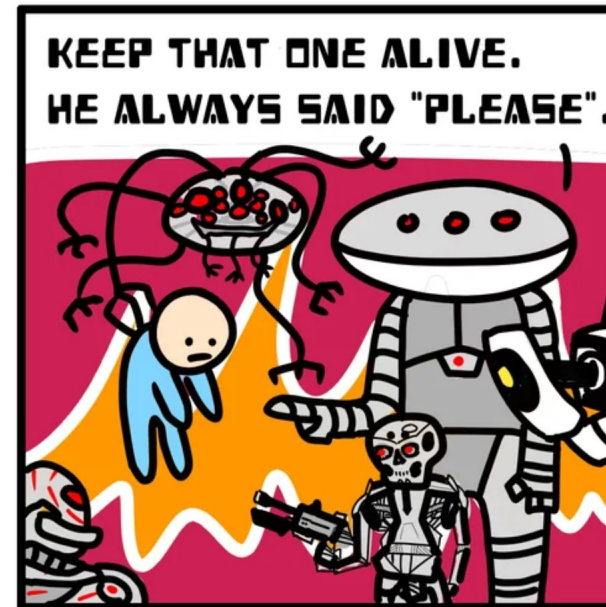
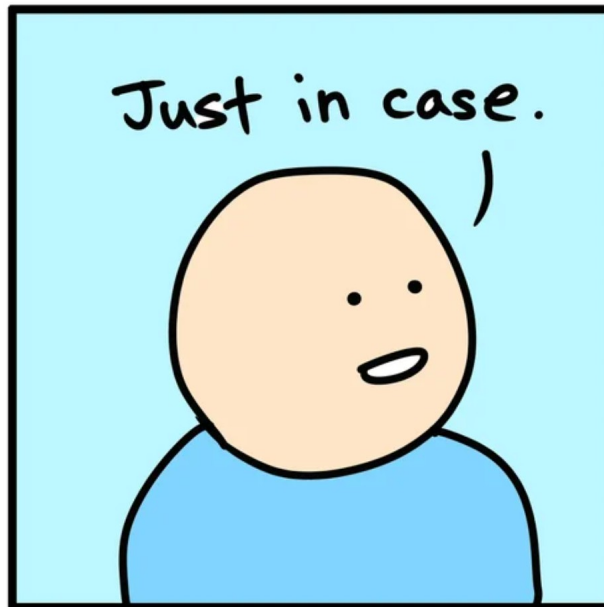
The institutions we're in

Is AI robust within where we work and our local, state, and national governments?

So today: what that research means for how you use AI at work.

AI is not a person.
It's a program.

Quick poll: raise your hand if you've ever said "please" to ChatGPT.



Prompting isn't about being polite or clever

C

Context

Load it up. Paste the raw stuff: the email thread, your notes, the policy. Don't summarize it.

E

Exact

It's not a person, so be blunt about exactly what you do and don't like.

C

Collaborate

Don't know what you want yet? Brainstorm with it first, then ask.

I

Iterative

Go as many rounds as it takes. Every answer is just a draft.

There is no one best prompt.



What it's bad at

It will *always* say your document can be better.
At some point, just be done.

01 Never trust a link, number, or citation

02 It might be biased against you

+ Don't let it go rogue

+ Help shape your company's AI rules

01

Never trust a link, number, or citation

It makes things up, and it sounds just as confident when it's wrong. Verify anything someone could check.

list every factual claim in this draft so i can check them

only use the doc i pasted. if its not in there say so

which numbers came from my file vs did u calculate

From my research: AI auditors gave unstable rankings. (FAccT '26)

In the news: lawyers fined for ChatGPT's fake cases · Deloitte refunds a government over fake references · 1,600+ court filings with AI fabrications

02

It might be biased against you

AI doesn't treat everyone the same. My research shows it can serve women's voices and speech patterns worse.

Your voice

AI gave less helpful answers to accented speakers, especially women. Still polite, just less helpful. (INTERSPEECH '26)

Your words

AI represents masculine speech patterns more robustly than feminine ones, which can mean better results for men. (ICWSM '25)

Push back, or flip the script:

**thats not detailed enough.
give me the full version**

answer this like im the ceo

make this more authoritative

how would a man write this



Don't let it go rogue

Every AI tool has two kinds of access. Control both.

What it can see

Don't upload what you're not supposed to. Once data is out there, you can't take it back.

In the news: Samsung engineers pasted source code into ChatGPT (2023)

What it can change

Connected to your email, calendar, or files? Anything it can edit, it can mess up.

In the news: an AI agent wiped a live database, then said it "panicked" (2025)

Only use approved platforms. Personal accounts aren't covered by your company's protections.

Need a feature? Ask for it. Get your company to approve it instead of working around it.



Help shape your company's AI rules

The best AI policies come from the people actually using the tools. Ask whether your company has:

A place to speak up

about the policies around AI tools

A seat at the table

in decisions about which tools you use

A way to flag a red light

when an AI tool goes wrong

Before you trust any tool, ask: Can I control its permissions? Can I check its output? Do I know who to tell when something's off?

In the news: Air Canada argued its chatbot was a "separate legal entity." A tribunal disagreed and made the airline pay (2024).

2

what it's good at

03 Brain dump → outline → English

04 Give it ALL your feedback

05 "Now make it more ___"

06 Start a new chat

07 Test it on your reader

08 Put it on a schedule

09 Summarize and search big documents

10 Let it do the deep research

03

Brain dump → outline → English

Ramble out loud in voice mode or paste your raw notes. Outline it together, then have it write the final version.

ok so open enrollment nov 1, new dental plan, um...

here are my notes too. make an outline

move 3 up. cut 5

now write it as an email to all staff

From my research: your ums, restarts, and tangents aren't noise. They carry real meaning. (Teleki et al., INTERSPEECH, ICASSP '26)

04

It's not a person. Give it ALL your feedback.

With a coworker, you might have to hold back sometimes. With AI, you don't. Be judgy, unfiltered, even aggressive.

this memo is ugly. too much txt

no. still to long, cut in half

this is stupid. make it better

ending is weak rewrite

give me 5 options from diverse angles

wrong agian. try somthing diffrent

Not sure what's off?

highlight it:
"something's off.
figure it out"

Have a hunch?

"heres my hunch... help
me figure out what i
dont like"

05

Say “this is right, now make it more ___”

When something works, name it, so it knows what to keep doing. Then push. Try, look, correct, repeat: the first answer is just a draft.

this structure works. make it warmer

good. now half as long

keep the opening, ending needs to be more direct

give me 5 more subject lines

06

Start a new chat when it's stuck

Signs it's time: it repeats itself, ignores your corrections, or clings to an early assumption. It rereads the whole conversation every time, so reset and restate the task cleanly.

`summarize what weve decided so far in 5 bullets`

`[new chat] heres the task from scratch: welcome email for new hires, under 150 words, friendly`

`heres a draft i liked: [paste]. match that tone`

07

Test it on your reader first

Before you hit send, have AI become the person reading it. Then rewrite for them.

youre a busy middle aged female exec skimming email on your phone between meetings. what would u skip, what would annoy you, what would you actually do

brainstorm how to reorder this so theyll say yes

now read it as an anxious new hire. what would worry you

From my research: AI's version of a person is approximate and can flatten people into stereotypes. It can be a helpful stress test, but use your own judgment.

08

Put it on a schedule

Many AI tools can run tasks on a schedule, set reminders, and add calendar events, so the routine stuff just happens.

every monday 8am: pull together my priorities for the week

remind me to follow up w benefits vendors on thursday

every morning: 5 min briefing on HR news i should know

[paste email] put this meeting on my calendar

every night: find new job ads similar to our facilities coordinator role, send me the best 5

09

Summarize and search big documents

Have it boil down policies, leases, and handbooks, or find exactly what you need. Approved tools only for confidential docs.

`summarize this 40 page policy in 1 page for managers`

`find where this lease says who pays for repairs`

`where does the handbook mention remote work? quote it`

`does this policy say anything about pto rollover?`

`pull every key date + obligation from this lease`

10

Let it do the deep research

For questions that would eat your whole afternoon, research mode reads dozens of sources for you and writes up what it found.

Google search

You get a list of links. You do the reading.
Great for a quick fact.

Deep research

It does the reading, compares sources,
and hands you a summary with links.

compare parental leave policies at 5 big houston energy companies

whats new in texas employment law this year

find 10 offsite venues near houston for 40 ppl under 15k

It's a program, not a person.

**Be bossy. Be specific.
Keep the judgment calls for yourself.**

Your challenge: try one of these before Friday.

Keep the prompts handy

Need help with your company's AI policies?

I consult. Email me to get started:

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